

highest percentage of prodigious accumulators of wealth. This group is significantly more likely to agree with this statement:

- ◆ Our household operates on a fairly well-thought-out annual budget.

To budget properly, one must keep records of disbursements. Here again, the used vehicle-prone shopper is more fastidious than any of the other types. More of them agree that:

- ◆ I know how much our family spends each year for food, clothing, and shelter.

Used vehicle-prone shoppers are also bargain-oriented when it comes to buying clothing. Their score of 145 was the highest overall (see [Table 4-4](#)). A significantly higher percentage agreed with this statement:

- ◆ I never bought a suit that was not on sale (discounted).

Used vehicle-prone shoppers are significantly more likely to be discount-store patrons than other types of vehicle buyers. This is evident from their positive response to the following statement:

- ◆ I often buy my suits at factory outlets.

In addition, they are significantly more frequent shoppers at Sears than any of the other types of millionaire vehicle buyers. This group, on average, spends considerably less for a variety of items. As discussed in Chapter 2, we asked all our millionaire respondents to tell us the most they ever paid for (1) a wristwatch, (2) a suit of clothing, and (3) a pair of shoes. Once again, the used vehicle-prone shopper demonstrated his frugality. Members of this group spent only 59 percent as much as the other millionaires in our survey for a wristwatch, 83 percent for a suit, and 88 percent for a pair of shoes.

The majority of people do not have the ability to increase their incomes significantly. Yet income is a positive correlate of wealth. What, then, is our message? If you cannot increase your compensation significantly, become wealthy some other way. Do it defensively. This is how most of the used vehicle-prone shoppers did it. They successfully inoculated themselves from contracting the high-consumption lifestyle that many of their neighbors adopted. *More than 70 percent of their*